

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ A J 9 5 2
 ♦ J 10 5 4
 ♣ 5 3

♠ A K Q J 8

♥ K 4

♦ K 3

♣ A K Q 4



♠ 9 5 2

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ 7 6 4

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ A 9 7 2

♣ 8 6

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North

This is definitely a 2♣ opening bid.

Partner responds 2♦, 7 points or less.

The formalities are over. Partner knows you have 22 or more points and you know he has 7 or fewer. Time to find a suit.

You bid 2♠ which partner raises to 3♠.

Partner's 3♠ bid is forward-going. With a complete bust he would have said 3♣ as a "second negative". So you use Blackwood. Partner shows one Ace and you bid the slam.

North plays 6♠. East leads the ♣J.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Between the ♥ loser and the ♣ loser which one can you eliminate? Easy question, fast losers like the ♥A are tough to eliminate. Usually you work on those slow losers.

The logical way to remove that ♣ loser is to ruff it in dummy. But do it carefully. It would be silly to play ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q and then try to ruff the ♣4. That is just begging for an over-ruff. It would be better to just take two rounds of ♣s, then ruff the ♣4. But even that isn't the best.

First take two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K. Then play two top ♣s. Only then do you ruff the ♣4.

You only needed one trump in dummy to ruff your one ♣ loser, so that made it right to pull two rounds of trumps first.

It made no difference in tricks whether you ruffed the third or fourth ♣ so that made it right to ruff the third one.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7 2

♥ J 4

♦ 7 6 2

♣ 6 5 3 2

♠ 5 3

♥ Q 10 6 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ K 9 7 4



♠ A J 8 6

♥ A K

♦ J 9 5

♣ A Q J 10

♠ 10 9 4

♥ 9 8 7 5 3

♦ A K 10 4

♣ 8

West

North

East

South

3 ♣

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Partner has 20-21 points, so with your 6 you belong in game. But which game?

You use Stayman convention to try to find out.

Partner responds 3 ♠.

You have at least 26 combined points and 8 ♠s. So you bid 4 ♠.

West would play 4 ♠.

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East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ 4. North wins the third trick with ♦ Q and plays a ♥.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ 4. North wins the third trick with ♦ Q and plays a ♥.

Since you've already lost the three ♦s you'd better not lose the ♣.

You must find North with the ♣K and you must be able to finesse three times. That means three dummy entries and they all must come from the trump suit.

Play the ♠A, then lead the ♠8 to dummy's ♠Q. Notice that you must save your ♠6. Pay attention to whether both defenders follow to both tricks. They do, and that means there is only one ♠ left out. Play a ♣ and finesse the ♣10. Now lead the ♠J to dummy's ♠K. Finesse the ♣J. Finally, lead the ♠6 to dummy's ♠7. Finesse the ♣Q. Claim the rest.

This was not an easy plan.

The first part is realizing that you need to have three entries to dummy.

The second part is figuring out that the ♠ suit could provide them.